

2. In a diffusion experiment, gelatin was mixed with a pink pH indicator and allowed to set. The gelatin was then cut into different sized cubes. The cubes were placed in a beaker containing dilute acid. As the acid diffused through the gelatin the cubes became colourless. The time taken to change from pink to colourless was recorded.

The surface area and volume of the cubes were calculated using the following equations:

$$\text{surface area of cube} = \text{length} \times \text{width} \times \text{number of sides}$$

$$\text{volume of cube} = \text{length} \times \text{width} \times \text{height}$$

- (a) The results of the experiment are shown below.

Length of side of gelatin cube (cm)	Time taken to become colourless (s)	Surface area of cube (cm ²)	Volume of cube (cm ³)	Surface area:volume ratio
1	20	6	1	6:1
5	41	150		6:5
7	104		343	6:7
10	610	600	1000	

- (i) **Complete** the table. [3]
- (ii) Sarah suggested that diffusion of the acid into the gelatin is quicker in the smaller cubes because the time taken for them to become colourless is less. Explain whether you agree with Sarah. [2]

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(b) Red blood cells transport oxygen around the body to allow respiration to occur in the tissues. Red blood cells have a volume of 90 units and a surface area of 136 units. Explain how the surface area:volume ratio of red blood cells make them suitable for their function. [3]

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